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Submitter Information

Name: Ashley

McCammon

Email: [REDACTED]

General Comment

As a creative professional and teacher, I've spent the last several years increasingly concerned about generative AI scraping and stealing from my body of work and those of my students and peers. It's incredibly alarming to witness the push for that theft to be made legal, unfettered or even condoned by our government. The fad around AI is just that - a fad, a speculative market no different on a broad scale than the NFT grift or cryptocurrency have been over the last decade. And in that fad, these programs provide poor/inaccurate results, and their process is terrible for our already-strained power grids. AI will not provide a secure ground to build on for the US as any kind of "powerhouse". It is, at best, a very simple tool with limited realistic uses at scale, and being full of snake oil salesmen as it is now, it has no clear place at any technological forefront.

If its use is a matter of "national security" for whatever reason, like OpenAI might claim, then they and companies like them can and should negotiate with creative workers directly, and pay us fairly for the privilege. Because our copyright protections are not "unnecessarily burdensome requirements" - it is a privilege for them, that all of our hard work would be saving their businesses and allowing them to remain competitive. I do not want my career, my hard work and years of education, or that of my students or my peers, to be used to bolster some failing corporation and their flash-in-the-pan tech fad that claims to be innovative. Real innovation does not require theft.

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